

**Medford Public Schools
Medford, Massachusetts**

Medford School Committee
Committee of the Whole
October 10, 2013

The Medford School Committee was called to order at 7:15 p.m. on Thursday October 10, 2013 by chairperson Paulette Van der Kloot in the Superintendent's Conference Room at Medford High School.

Members present: Ann Marie Cugno, Erin DiBenedetto, John Falco (arrived at 8:00 p.m.), George Scarpelli, Robert E. Skerry Jr. (arrived at 7:30 p.m.) and Paulette Van der Kloot. Also present were Superintendent Roy E. Belson, Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson, Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell, all department heads and principals. (6 present 1 absent)

All rose to salute the Flag.

Superintendent Belson provided an overview of the 2013 testing results.

Nicole Chiesa presented an in depth analysis of the MCAS English Language Arts results (see attached analysis and sample questions.) Ms. Chiesa discussed the importance of the new reading/literacy program.

Carolyn Joy presented an in depth analysis of the MCAS math and science results (see attached analysis and sample questions). Ms. Joy showed that the various cohorts had year to year similarities. She felt that a lot could be learned by looking at the longitudinal results of the specific cohorts. There is a new pilot math program (Envision) at the elementary level that is promising. It could replace Everyday Math if funding is available.

Bernadette Ricciardelli and Leslie Trotta presented information on the various subgroups and provided data on district comparisons.

Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson talked about testing variables that affect outcomes.

Deputy Superintendent Nelson cited:

- New curriculum frameworks (Common Core)
- Teaching staff changes
- Instructional time variables
- Changing cohorts
- Different subgroups at schools

Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell provided a summary of elementary and middle school results. Ms. Caldwell explained that administrators need to ask three questions as follows:

- How do principals review MCAS results with staff?
- How do we ensure all students are prepared to take MCAS?
- Moving forward, how can we better prepare our students for MCAS?

She talked about the use of the DESE Edwin Analytics for data. Also about MCAS supports at different school including RTI and Study Island. (see attached)

While there are many important highlights to this year's results especially at the 10th grade level, there are concerns about our 3rd and 4th grade student results. The Administration will be looking at additional ways to provide extra help at these grade levels. It was recognized that different cohorts take the test each year at the various grade levels and that this can cause some variance.

The School Committee felt that more is needed to be done to market and publicize Medford success. We need strong public relations.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry the meeting was adjourned (6-0-1) at 9:21 p.m.

Respectfully Submitted,

Paulette Van der Kloot
Chairperson – pro tem